

Internal — RYM onboarding. Share this PDF with new hires (not the source file).

Cursor + IFP + MSTR — New User Guide

Version for new hires — read top to bottom. Do not skip the “Where do I start?” page.

PAGE 1 — Where do I start? (read this first)

You only need ONE file today:

What	Where
This guide (PDF)	ifp-frequency-cap-tests/docs/NEW-USER-SIMPLE- GUIDE.pdf
Live training slides (optional)	Ask trainer for training-guide.pptx

Ignore other files in docs/ until you are comfortable. Your trainer uses hidden source files to rebuild this PDF.

Which part of this guide do I need?

I need to...	Go to page / section
Install Cursor from scratch	Part A — Download Cursor
First-day computer setup (folders, Python, MCP)	Part B — Day 1 setup
Open Cursor Settings, MCP green, Run Mode	Part C — Cursor Settings
Learn Agent vs Ask, New Chat, Run/Skip buttons	Part D — Chat & approvals
Copy-paste first exercises in Cursor	Part E — Startup prompts
Run an IFP forecast every day	Part F — IFP day to day
Copy targeting from IFP website (F12)	Part G — IFP DevTools lab
Daily MSTR email + Excel report	Part H — MSTR day to day
Schedule weekly/daily MSTR emails	Part I — Mission Control
Something broke	Part J — Fix it

The three jobs (pick yours)

Job	What you do	VPN?
IFP forecast	Type in Cursor chat → get capacity/available	Yes (Hulu VPN)
MSTR daily report	Cursor runs script → Outlook draft → you Send	No (need Outlook)
Mission Control	Schedule MSTR emails in browser (setup once)	Per your org

Day 1 order (check off as you go)

- ☐ Part A — Install Cursor
 - ☐ Part B — Get folders, Python, mcp.json, MCP green
 - ☐ Part C — Settings (MCP + Run Mode)
 - ☐ Part D — Read how Agent and Run buttons work
 - ☐ Part E — Do startup prompts (Ask then Agent)
 - ☐ Part F — One test forecast (VPN on)
 - ☐ Part H — Only if you own the daily report
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PART A — Download Cursor (every click)

You need Cursor **before** anything else.

A1. Open the website

1. Open **Chrome** or **Edge**.
2. Click the address bar at the top.
3. Type: **cursor.com**
4. Press **Enter**.

A2. Download

1. On the Cursor home page, click the **Download** button.
2. If it asks **Windows** or **Mac**, choose **Windows**.
3. Wait for the file to download (often in your **Downloads** folder).
4. The file name is usually like **Cursor Setup.exe**.

A3. Install

1. Open **Downloads** in File Explorer.
2. Double-click **Cursor Setup.exe**.
3. If Windows asks “Do you want to allow this app to make changes?” click **Yes**.
4. Follow the installer (**Next** → **Install** → **Finish**).

A4. First open

1. Open Cursor from the **Start menu** (search “Cursor”).
2. If it asks you to **Sign in**, sign in (use work account if IT requires it).
3. If it asks about importing VS Code settings, you can click **Skip** or **Continue** — either is fine.
4. Optional: **Help** menu → **Check for Updates**.

A5. Pin it (optional)

1. With Cursor open, right-click its icon on the taskbar → **Pin to taskbar**.

Done with Part A. Continue to Part B.

PART B — Day 1 setup (one time only)

Ask a teammate to sit with you for **B4–B7** if you get stuck.

B1. Check access

1. Connect **Hulu VPN** — confirm it works.
2. Open **<https://ifp-portal-prod.aor.prod.hulu.com/home>** — confirm you can log in (SSO).
3. Ask trainer for **git links** or **two zip files** for the folders below.

B2. Create your projects folder

1. Open **File Explorer**.
2. Go to `c:\Users\` and open **your** folder (your Windows name).
3. If there is no **projects** folder: right-click → **New** → **Folder** → name it **projects**.

B3. Get two folders on your PC

You must have **both** of these when done:

```
C:\Users\YourName\projects\ifp-frequency-cap-tests  
C:\Users\YourName\projects\ifp-mcp-server
```

Option 1 — Git (trainer gives you URLs):

1. Press **Windows key**, type **PowerShell**, press **Enter**.
2. Copy/paste (trainer replaces the URLs):

```
cd C:\Users\YourName\projects  
git clone https://YOUR-TEAM-URL/ifp-frequency-cap-tests.git  
git clone https://YOUR-TEAM-URL/ifp-mcp-server.git
```

Option 2 — Zip files:

1. Unzip both zips.
2. Move folders so names and paths match exactly above.

Folder	You use it for...
ifp-frequency-cap-tests	Open this in Cursor every day for IFP

ifp-mcp-server	Holds server.py — Cursor starts it; you rarely open this folder
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B4. Install Python (for IFP helper only)

1. Install **Python 3** from **python.org** (or IT installer). Check **Add to PATH** if offered.
2. In PowerShell:

```
py --version
```

1. You should see a version number. Then:

```
py -m pip install -r C:\Users\YourName\projects\ifp-mcp-server\requirements.txt
```

B5. Create mcp.json (personal settings file)

This file is **on your PC only** — not in the git folders.

1. File Explorer → C:\Users\YourName\
2. **View** → turn on **Hidden items**
3. Open folder **.cursor** (create it if missing)
4. Create file **mcp.json**
5. Trainer sends you this block — replace **YourName** with your Windows username:

```
{ "mcpServers": { "ifp-forecast": { "type": "stdio", "command": "py", "args": [
"C:/Users/YourName/projects/ifp-mcp-server/server.py" ], "env": { "IFP_API_URL":
"http://inventory-forecasting-prod-dplus.ava.prod.hulu.com/v1/inventory/forecast",
"IFP_SOURCE_HEADER": "RYM Frequency Cap Test", "IFP_TESTS_ROOT":
"C:/Users/YourName/projects/ifp-frequency-cap-tests" } } } }
```

1. **Save** the file.

B6. Reload Cursor

1. In Cursor: **Ctrl+Shift+P**
2. Type **Reload Window**
3. Press **Enter**

B7. Open IFP folder in Cursor

1. **File** → **Open Folder**
2. Select **ifp-frequency-cap-tests**
3. Left sidebar should show **config**, **docs**, **scripts**, etc.

Part B done. Next: Part C (Settings).

PART C — Cursor Settings (where to click)

C1. Open Settings

Step	Action
1	Click gear icon bottom-left of Cursor OR press Ctrl+ ,
2	A settings panel opens

C2. Check MCP (IFP helper connected)

Step	Action
3	In settings search box, type MCP
4	Find server name ifp-forecast
5	Status must be green
6	If red : click for logs → ask trainer (usually wrong path in mcp.json or Part B4 failed)

C3. Set Run Mode (Run / Always / Ask — important for new users)

When the Agent runs commands or IFP tools, Cursor may show **Run**, **Skip**, or **Add to allowlist**.

Step	Action
7	In settings search, type Run Mode or Agents
8	Open Agents → Approvals & Execution (wording may vary)
9	For new hires , choose a mode that asks before running things

Run Mode (name in Settings)	What it means for you
-----------------------------	-----------------------

Allowlist (empty list)	Cursor asks before almost every command/MCP action
Auto-review	Some things run automatically after a review — fewer popups
Run everything	Do not use on day 1 — things run without asking

1. **Trainer tip:** Until you are comfortable, pick the strictest mode your IT allows.

C4. After any mcp.json edit

1. **Ctrl+Shift+P → Reload Window**

Part C done.

PART D — Chat, Agent, New Chat, Run buttons

D1. Open chat

1. Press **Ctrl+I**
2. Chat panel opens (usually on the right)

D2. Start a NEW chat (do this for each new task)

1. At top of chat panel, click **+** or **New Chat**
2. Why: old messages confuse the Agent

D3. Pick the mode (top of chat panel)

Mode	When to use	Can it change files / run IFP?
Ask	Learning, explaining JSON	No — safe for practice
Agent	Forecasts, scripts, edits	Yes — with your approval
Plan	Big multi-step jobs	Makes a plan first, then Agent runs

1. **IFP forecast** → use **Agent**
2. **“What does this file mean?”** → use **Ask**

D4. Pick a model (optional)

1. Dropdown at top of chat — leave **team default** unless IT says otherwise

D5. When you see approval buttons

For terminal commands and MCP (IFP) tools:

Button	What to do
Run / Approve	OK this one time — only if VPN is on (for IFP) and request matches what you asked
Skip / Reject	Do not run — ask trainer

Add to allowlist	Trust for later — ask trainer before using
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For file edits (separate from Run):

Button	What to do
Accept	Keep the file change
Reject	Undo the change

PART E — Startup prompts (new hire — do in order)

Open `ifp-frequency-cap-tests` in Cursor first.

E1. Ask mode — no VPN needed

1. **Ctrl+I** → **New Chat** → mode **Ask**
2. Paste and send:

```
Explain reference/cap-ratio-expectations.json in simple terms. What is one test case?
```

1. **New Chat** → **Ask** → paste:

```
What is the DMA code for Baton Rouge? Use reference/dma-codes.json.
```

1. **New Chat** → **Ask** → paste:

```
Explain config/base-request.json – dates and main targeting only. Do not change any files.
```

E2. Agent mode — creates one practice file

1. **New Chat** → mode **Agent**
2. Paste:

```
Create practice-notes.md with 4 bullets summarizing caps, DMA codes, and base-request.json.
```

1. Read the diff → **Accept** if OK

E3. Agent + VPN — one live forecast

1. Turn **Hulu VPN** on
2. **New Chat** → **Agent**
3. Paste:

```
Use ifp_server_info to show configuration.
```

1. If Cursor shows MCP approval → read tool name → **Run**
2. Paste:

Run a forecast for July 8, 2026, Hulu US, Baton Rouge, 2 per hour. Show capacity and available.

1. If approval appears again → **Run** (VPN must be on)

Part E done — you are set up to use Cursor for IFP.

PART F — IFP day to day (every forecast)

Repeat these steps each time.

Step	Do this
1	Hulu VPN on
2	Cursor → File → Open Folder → ifp-frequency-cap-tests
3	Ctrl+I → New Chat → Agent
4	Type your request in plain English, e.g.: Run a forecast for [date], Hulu US, [city], [N] per hour. Show capacity and available.
5	Click Run on any MCP approval if prompted
6	Read capacity and available in the reply

Cap units: only **MINUTE**, **HOURL**, or **DAY** (e.g. 4 per 30 DAY for monthly-style caps).

City names: portal shows names; API uses **numbers** — ask Cursor or check `reference/dma-codes.json`.

PART G — IFP DevTools lab (targeting exercise)

Use when **numbers don't match the portal** or **product/targeting changed**.

Goal: Copy the exact request the portal sends → save into `config/base-request.json`.

G1. Portal setup

1. **VPN on**
2. Browser → **`https://ifp-portal-prod.aor.prod.hulu.com/home`**
3. Log in
4. Build the forecast in the UI exactly like the deal:
5. Dates
6. Product (note **product-id**)
7. Targeting (publishers, country, DMA, etc.)
8. Frequency cap

G2. Open Developer Tools

1. Press **F12** on keyboard (or **Ctrl+Shift+I**)
2. A panel opens — usually at bottom or side of browser
3. Click tab **Network**
4. Check box **Preserve log** (keeps requests after page changes)
5. Click filter **Fetch/XHR** (hides images/CSS)

G3. Capture the request

1. In the portal, click **Run forecast / Submit**
2. In Network list, find a row containing **forecast** in the name or URL
3. **Click that row**
4. On the right, open **Payload** or **Request** (Chrome) / **Request** body (Edge)
5. Copy the **JSON request body** — **NOT** the Response tab

G4. Save into project

1. In Cursor, open `config/base-request.json`
2. Replace contents with copied JSON **or** ask Agent:

Help me update config/base-request.json with this portal request payload: [paste JSON here]

1. **Save** the file
2. **VPN on** → run **Part F** again → compare numbers to portal

Important: Picking a product in the portal fills targeting **in the browser only**. The saved JSON must include full **targeting-detail**, not just product-id.

PART H — MSTR day to day (daily publishers report)

Different job from IFP. You need folder `all-publishers-daily-report`.

Step	Do this
1	Wait for MicroStrategy email in Outlook (often from <code>microstrategy-prod@dpdo.info</code>) with today's .xlsx attachments
2	Cursor → File → Open Folder → <code>all-publishers-daily-report</code>
3	Ctrl+I → New Chat → Agent
4	Type: <code>Run dailypublisherscript.py</code>
5	Click Run if Cursor asks to run terminal commands
6	Script updates Excel and opens an Outlook draft
7	You review the draft and click Send — Cursor does not send email for you

If email is missing: check **Part I (Mission Control)** schedule or ask analytics teammate.

PART I — Mission Control (schedule MSTR emails)

Mission Control = MicroStrategy tool to **schedule** report emails. You set this up **once** (or verify existing schedules); it is **not** Cursor.

URL: Ask your manager for **MicroStrategy Library** and **Mission Control** links. Paste team URL here when known: _____

I1. Find your report in Library

1. Connect VPN/network per org rules
2. Open **MicroStrategy Library** (browser) → SSO login
3. Search **All Publisher Daily Report** (or your team's report name)
4. Open the report to confirm it looks correct

I2. Create or edit a subscription in Mission Control

1. Open **Mission Control** (from Library menu or direct link)
2. Click **Create subscription** or **New schedule** (wording varies)
3. Select the report
4. Set **Recurrence:**
5. **Daily** — for daily report script (email must arrive before you run Part H)
6. **Weekly** — for weekly pulls/dashboards
7. Set **Format: Excel** (.xlsx) if the daily script expects Excel
8. Set **Delivery:** email to your team distribution list
9. **Save**
10. Run a **test** — confirm email arrives in Outlook

I3. Weekly checklist (example)

When	Action
Each business day	MSTR email arrived? → Part H daily script
Weekly	Mission Control job succeeded? (ask analytics if emails stop)
After IFP deal change	Part G DevTools → Part F test forecast

PART J — Fix it

Problem	Try this
Forecast fails / timeout	VPN on?
MCP red in Settings	Trainer checks <code>mcp.json</code> paths + Part B4 pip install + Reload Window
"Python was not found"	Use py not python
Cursor ran something scary	Part C3 — stricter Run Mode; use Ask when learning
IFP numbers $\neq$ portal	Part G — missing targeting in <code>base-request.json</code>
No MSTR email today	Part I — subscription failed or late
PowerShell script blocked	<code>Set-ExecutionPolicy -Scope CurrentUser RemoteSigned</code> (once)

Never paste passwords or tokens in chat.

PART K — Who to ask

Question	Ask
Cursor install, git, mcp.json	Your trainer
IFP wrong numbers / product	IFP owner on team
Daily report / Outlook / Excel	Daily report owner
Mission Control / MSTR schedules	Analytics teammate
IT / VPN / SSO	IT help desk

Quick reference

Item	Location
This guide (PDF)	docs/NEW-USER-SIMPLE-GUIDE.pdf
IFP folder to open in Cursor	...\ifp-frequency-cap-tests
MCP config	C:\Users\You\.cursor\mcp.json
IFP portal	https://ifp-portal-prod.aor.prod.hulu.com/home
Open chat	Ctrl+I
Open Settings	Ctrl+,
Reload Cursor	Ctrl+Shift+P → Reload Window

End of guide.